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Python Libraries and Tools

Optional Topics

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Choosing Topics

- The optional modules are selected with the trainer to suit the group.
- Command-line programs and subprocesses support scripting and automation.
- The modern toolbelt covers progress displays, formatted output and HTTP.
- Web scraping and SQLAlchemy cover collecting and storing records.
- NumPy and pandas cover arrays, tables and reports.
- GUI toolkits introduce desktop windows.
- Inheritance previews Advanced Python and can be skipped.
- The supplied data and database seed let later modules run independently.

Inheritance

Inheritance
Command-line Programs
Modern Toolbelt
Web Scraping
SQLAlchemy
NumPy
Pandas
GUI Toolkits
APPENDIX Running Other Programs

Inheritance
Duplicated Code
Cost of Duplication
Base Classes and Subclasses
Inherited Members
Constructor Chaining
Overriding Methods
Extending with super
isinstance and issubclass

str and repr
Polymorphism
Abstract Base Classes
Enforcing the Contract
Composition
Scraper Toolkit
Advanced Python Topics
Summary : Inheritance

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Inheritance

- A subclass inherits behaviour from a base class
- Related objects can share an interface while supplying different methods
- `Mage`, `Warrior` and `Priest` specialise `Character`
- Health, mana and rage values here are simplified teaching data

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Duplicated Code

- Both classes initialise a name and health
- A change to shared behaviour requires editing both implementations
- A base class can hold that common behaviour

```
class Mage:
    def __init__(self, name: str) -> None:
        self.name: str = name
        self.health: int = 100
        self.mana: int = 100


class Warrior:
    def __init__(self, name: str) -> None:
        self.name: str = name
        self.health: int = 100
        self.rage: int = 0
```

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Cost of Duplication

- Repeated logic can diverge when one copy changes
- Inheritance puts shared behaviour in one implementation
- Subclasses retain their specific state and methods

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Base Classes and Subclasses

- A subclass names its base in parentheses
- The base implementation remains available through the subclass
- An empty subclass can inherit the initialiser and methods unchanged

```
class Character:
    def __init__(self, name: str) -> None:
        self.name: str = name
        self.health: int = 100

    def attack(self) -> str:
        return f"{self.name} attacks"

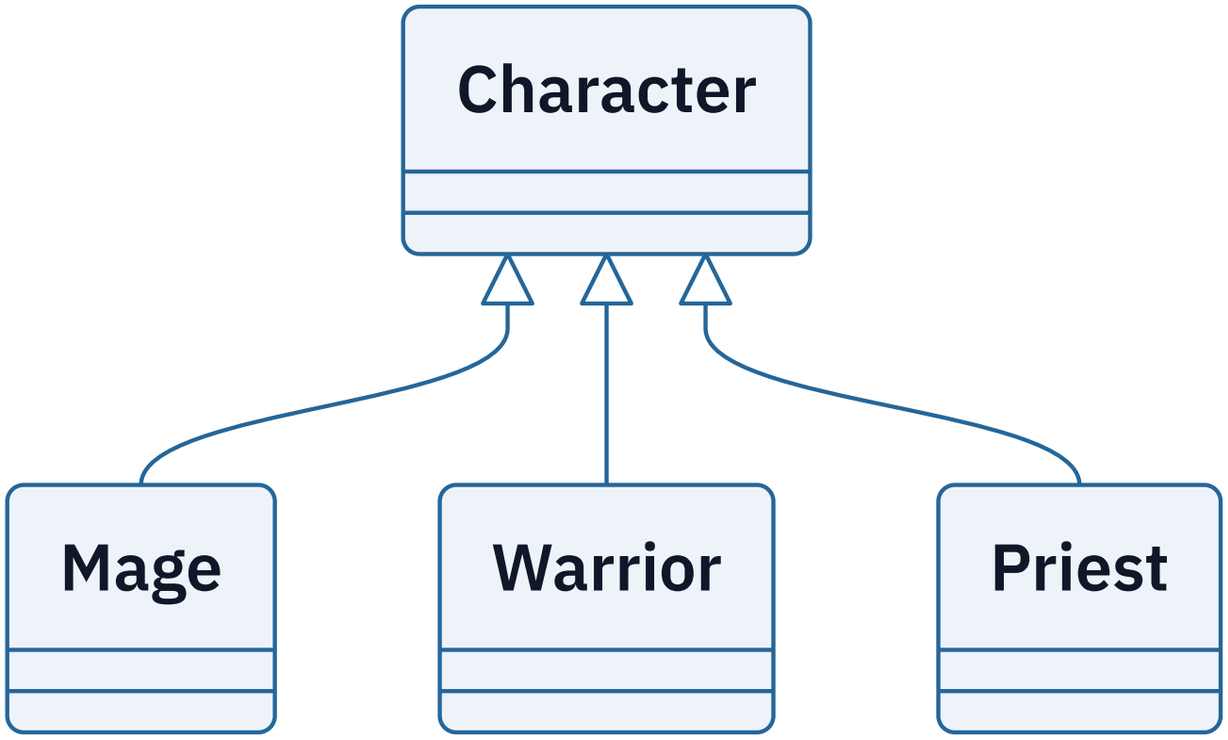

class Mage(Character):
    pass
```

demo02 · subclass

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Inherited Members

- Inherited methods are found through the class hierarchy
- The base initialiser creates attributes on the actual subclass instance
- The object remains an instance of both its class and its base



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Constructor Chaining

- A subclass initialiser can call `super().__init__`
- The base initialiser stores shared attributes on the same object
- The subclass then adds its own attributes

```
class Mage(Character):
    def __init__(self, name: str, mana: int = 100) -> None:
        super().__init__(name)
        self.mana: int = mana
```

demo03 · super_init

Overriding Methods

- Defining the same method name in a subclass overrides the base method
- Method lookup starts at the instance's class and follows its method resolution order
- `Mage.attack` is found before `Character.attack`

```
def attack(self) -> str:
        return f"{self.name} casts Frostbolt"

jaina = Mage("Jaina")
print(jaina.attack())
print(Character.attack(jaina))
```

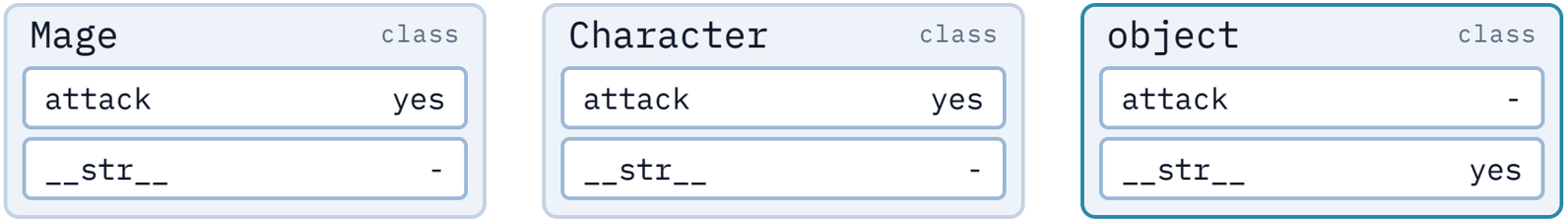
demo04 · overriding

Method Lookup

```
jaina = Mage("Jaina")
print(jaina.attack())
print(Character.attack(jaina))
print([cls.__name__ for cls in Mage.__mro__])
print(Mage.__str__ is object.__str__)
```

OUTPUT

```
Jaina casts Frostbolt
Jaina attacks
['Mage', 'Character', 'object']
True
```



Neither course class defines __str__; the inherited method belongs to object.

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Extending with super

- `super()` delegates according to the method resolution order
- An initialiser can extend shared setup without copying it
- Both initialisers receive the same `self` object

```
class Mage(Character):
    def __init__(self, name: str, mana: int = 100) -> None:
        super().__init__(name)
        self.mana: int = mana
```

Initialising One Mage

```
class Mage(Character):
    def __init__(self, name: str, mana: int = 100) -> None:
        super().__init__(name)
        self.mana: int = mana


jaina = Mage("Jaina", mana=80)
print(vars(jaina))
```

Character.__init__

sets	name, health

jaina — Mage object

name	'Jaina'
health	100
mana	80

OUTPUT

```
{'name': 'Jaina',
'health': 100, 'mana': 80}
```

The subclass stores mana after super returns.

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isinstance and issubclass

- `isinstance` includes inherited relationships
- `issubclass` asks about classes rather than instances
- Exact `type(...)` equality excludes subclass instances

```
jaina = Mage("Jaina")
print(isinstance(jaina, Mage))
print(isinstance(jaina, Character))
print(issubclass(Mage, Character))
print(type(jaina) is Character)
```

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str and repr

- `__str__` supplies a readable display value
- `__repr__` supplies a debugging representation
- Containers display their elements with `repr`

```
def __str__(self) -> str:
        return self.name

    def __repr__(self) -> str:
        return f"{type(self).__name__}(name={self.name!r})"
```

demo06 · str_and_repr

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Polymorphism

- One loop can call the same method on different subclass instances
- Each object supplies its own implementation
- The caller does not need a branch for each class

```
raid: list[Character] = [Mage("Jaina"), Warrior("Varian"), Priest("Anduin")]
for member in raid:
    print(member.attack())
```

demo07 · polymorphism

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Abstract Base Classes

- `ABC` and `abstractmethod` declare a required method
- A concrete subclass must implement every abstract method
- Abstract classes can also provide ordinary methods and initialisers

```
class Ability(ABC):
    @abstractmethod
    def cast(self) -> str:
        """Return the ability's action."""


class Frostbolt(Ability):
    def cast(self) -> str:
        return "Frostbolt deals frost damage"
```

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Enforcing the Contract

- An incomplete subclass fails when it is instantiated
- The error names the missing abstract method
- A concrete subclass remains an ordinary Python class

```
try:
    UnfinishedAbility()
except TypeError as error:
    print(f"TypeError: {error}")
```

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Composition

- A character has a mount and an inventory
- Composition stores collaborating objects in attributes
- Inheritance describes a kind of object; composition describes what it holds

```
class Character:
    def __init__(self, name: str, mount: Mount) -> None:
        self.name: str = name
        self.mount: Mount = mount
        self.inventory: Inventory = Inventory()
```

demo09 · composition

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Scraper Toolkit

- An abstract scraper defines `parse` and shares collection behaviour
- Books and quotes supply different parsers behind the same interface
- This applied example uses local records and makes no network requests
- The scraping module applies the same separation to HTML

demo10 · scraper_toolkit

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Advanced Python Topics

- **Advanced Python extends this introduction :**
  - Multiple inheritance and mixins
  - Protocols, descriptors and metaclasses
- **These mechanisms are not required for the remaining libraries modules**

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Summary : Inheritance

- Base classes share state and behaviour with subclasses
- Overrides supply specialised implementations
- `super` extends inherited behaviour on the same object
- Polymorphic calls use the implementation supplied by each object
- Abstract methods enforce a contract; composition stores collaborators

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Command-line Programs

Inheritance

Command-line Programs

Modern Toolbelt

Web Scraping

SQLAlchemy

NumPy

Pandas

GUI Toolkits

APPENDIX Running Other Programs

Command-line Programs

sys.argv

Manual Argument Parsing

ArgumentParser

Options and Flags

Mutually Exclusive Options

Generated Help and Errors

Subcommands

Path Arguments

FileType

main and the Exit Status

Standard Output and Standard Error

Inline Script Metadata

Executable Scripts

Command-line Checklist

Summary : Command-line Programs

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Command-line Programs

- A command-line tool accepts arguments and options
- Standard output carries results; standard error carries diagnostics
- Exit statuses let the shell distinguish success, matches and errors
- A playlist report can share one interface across scripts and pipelines

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sys.argv

- `sys.argv[0]` is the script name
- The remaining entries are strings supplied by the caller
- Parsing and validation are separate from receiving those strings

```
arguments = sys.argv[1:] or ["tracks.csv", "--genre", "Rock", "--limit", "3"]
print(f"program: {Path(sys.argv[0]).name}")
for position, value in enumerate(arguments, start=1):
    print(f"argv[{position}] = {value!r}")

line = "2026-10-12 08:00:00 INFO PLAY Imagine"
print(line.split(maxsplit=4))
```

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Manual Argument Parsing

- Manual parsing must recognise every option and its values
- Missing values, invalid conversions and unknown options need error handling
- `argparse` supplies these checks and generated help

```
elif argv[index] == "--limit":
            index += 1
            limit = int(argv[index])
```

demo02 · argv_by_hand

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ArgumentParser

- A positional argument is required unless configured otherwise
- `type=int` converts its text before the program uses it
- A duration in seconds can be formatted as minutes and seconds

```
def format_duration(seconds: int) -> str:
    return f"{seconds // 60}:{seconds % 60:02d}"

parser = argparse.ArgumentParser(description="Format a track duration.")
parser.add_argument("seconds", type=int, help="duration in seconds")
args = parser.parse_args(sys.argv[1:] or ["183"])
print(format_duration(args.seconds))
```

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Options and Flags

- Dashed names define optional arguments
- `default` supplies a value when an option is absent
- `store_true` creates a flag; `count` counts repeated flags
- `choices` rejects unsupported values

```
parser.add_argument("file", type=Path, nargs="?", default=DATA / "tracks.csv")
parser.add_argument("--genre", choices=["Rock", "Pop", "Soul", "Country", "Electronic"])
parser.add_argument("--limit", type=int, default=5)
parser.add_argument("-v", "--verbose", action="count", default=0)
parser.add_argument("--dry-run", action="store_true")
```

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Mutually Exclusive Options

- A mutually exclusive group accepts at most one member
- Supplying both duration-order flags is a usage error
- Parsing rejects the conflict with exit status 2

```
order = parser.add_mutually_exclusive_group()
order.add_argument("--longest", action="store_true")
order.add_argument("--shortest", action="store_true")
```

demo05 · mutually_exclusive

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Generated Help and Errors

- `--help` describes declared arguments and options
- A missing required value or invalid conversion writes a usage error to stderr
- Help exits with status 0; usage errors exit with status 2

```
parser = argparse.ArgumentParser(prog="duration", description="Format seconds.")
parser.add_argument("seconds", type=int)
```

demo06 · help_and_errors

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Subcommands

- `add_subparsers` registers verbs such as `list`, `stats` and `top`
- Each subparser owns its arguments
- `set_defaults(handler=...)` attaches the implementation function

```
verbs = parser.add_subparsers(dest="command", required=True)
    listing = verbs.add_parser("list", help="list tracks")
    listing.add_argument("--genre")
    listing.add_argument("--limit", type=int, default=5)
    listing.set_defaults(handler=cmd_list)
```

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Path Arguments

- `type=Path` converts an argument into a path object
- Conversion does not prove that a file exists or is readable
- Open files after parsing, inside a context manager

```
parser = argparse.ArgumentParser()
parser.add_argument("file", type=Path, nargs="?", default=DATA / "tracks.csv")
args = parser.parse_args()
if not args.file.is_file():
    print(f"Missing file: {args.file}", file=sys.stderr)
    raise SystemExit(2)
```

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FileType

- `argparse.FileType` opens a file while parsing
- It is pending deprecation in Python 3.14
- A later parsing failure can leave the file open
- A `Path` argument followed by `with path.open(...)` gives control over its lifetime

```
with args.source.open(encoding="utf-8") as stream:
    print(f"opened {args.source.name}, first line: {stream.readline().strip()}")
```

demo09 · filetype

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main and the Exit Status

- `raise SystemExit(main(...))` forwards a result to the shell
- Status 0 means success; nonzero statuses describe other outcomes
- This playlist tool returns 2 when its input cannot be read

```
try:
        rows = load(args.file)
    except OSError as error:
        print(f"playlist: {error}", file=sys.stderr)
        return 2
```

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Standard Output and Standard Error

- Stdout carries results that another program can read
- Stderr carries diagnostics without mixing them into the data
- `BrokenPipeError` can occur when a downstream program stops reading

```
def emit(path: Path) -> None:
    print(f"Reading {path.name}", file=sys.stderr)
    for row in load(path):
        print(row["title"])
    print("Finished", file=sys.stderr)
```

demo11 · stderr_and_pipes

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Inline Script Metadata

- PEP 723 records script dependencies in a comment block
- `uv run script.py` reads the metadata and prepares an environment
- The script can remain one file

```
# /// script
# requires-python = ">=3.12"
# dependencies = ["rich>=13.9"]
# ///
```

demo12 · pep723_script

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Executable Scripts

- A shebang selects the interpreter on systems that support it
- A script still needs executable permission on Linux and macOS
- On Windows, invoke the script through `uv run`

```
#!/usr/bin/env -S uv run --script
```

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Command-line Checklist

- Provide generated help and validate arguments
- Accept an input path or a documented stdin marker
- Keep diagnostic messages on stderr
- Use exit statuses consistently; handle missing files and broken pipes

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Summary : Command-line Programs

- Read arguments with `argparse`
- Declare positionals, options, exclusive flags and subcommands
- Convert paths while parsing; open files afterwards
- Separate stdout, stderr and exit status
- PEP 723 can declare dependencies beside the script

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Modern Toolbelt

Inheritance

Command-line Programs

Modern Toolbelt

Web Scraping

SQLAlchemy

NumPy

Pandas

GUI Toolkits

APPENDIX Running Other Programs

Useful Libraries

tqdm Progress Bars

Nested Bars

Manual Bar Updates

tqdm.write

rich Console

rich Tables

rich Progress

rich Tracebacks

rich inspect

rich Logging Handler

HTTP with httpx

requests and httpx

typer

typer Trade-offs

Finding Libraries

Judging a Library

Summary : Modern Toolbelt

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Useful Libraries

- `tqdm` adds progress bars to loops
- `rich` renders tables, progress, object details and tracebacks
- `httpx` supplies an HTTP client and an offline mock transport
- `typer` builds command-line interfaces from annotated functions

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tqdm Progress Bars

- `tqdm` wraps an iterable without changing its values
- `desc` labels the work; `unit` labels each item
- Pass `total=` when the iterable has no known length

```
for _track in tqdm(tracks, desc="Converting", unit="track"):
    time.sleep(0.01)  # Simulated conversion; no audio files are read.
print(f"Converted {len(tracks)} track records")
rows = (track for track in tracks)
for _track in tqdm(rows, total=len(tracks), desc="From a generator"):
    pass
```

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Nested Bars

- An outer bar can count albums and an inner bar tracks
- `leave=False` removes each completed inner bar

```
albums = {"Imagine": ["Imagine", "Jealous Guy"],
          "Thriller": ["Thriller", "Billie Jean"]}
for album, titles in tqdm(albums.items(), desc="Albums"):
    for _title in tqdm(titles, desc=album, leave=False):
        time.sleep(0.02)
```

demo02 · tqdm_nested

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Manual Bar Updates

- Create a bar with a known total, then call `update`
- A context manager closes the bar when the work finishes
- `set_postfix` displays additional progress values

```
with tqdm(total=len(tracks), desc="Converting", unit="track") as bar:
    for track in tracks:
        time.sleep(0.01)
        bar.update(1)
        bar.set_postfix(title=track["title"][:12])
```

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tqdm.write

- `tqdm.write` prints a message while preserving the progress display
- Ordinary terminal writes can interrupt a running bar

```
for track in tqdm(tracks, desc="Checking"):
    if not track["last_played"]:
        tqdm.write(f"Never played: {track['title']}")
```

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rich Console

- `Console.print` handles markup and Python objects
- Markup uses bracketed style names and `[/]` to close a style
- `Console(stderr=True)` sends diagnostics to standard error

```
console = Console()
console.rule("Playlist")
console.print("[bold]Now playing [cyan]Imagine[/][/] ")
console.print({"title": "Imagine", "duration_s": 183})
```

demo05 · rich_console

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rich Tables

- Declare columns, then add rows
- Column options control alignment and wrapping
- Row styles and footers can distinguish and summarise entries

```
table = Table(title="Top tracks", row_styles=["", "dim"])
table.add_column("Title", style="cyan")
table.add_column("Plays", justify="right")
for track in sorted(tracks, key=lambda row: int(row["plays"]), reverse=True)[:5]:
    table.add_row(track["title"], track["plays"])
table.show_footer = True
table.columns[0].footer = "Shown"
table.columns[1].footer = "5"
Console().print(table)
```

demo06 · rich_table

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rich Progress

- `track` wraps an iterable with a progress display
- `Progress` supports several tasks and explicit updates
- Its console keeps messages aligned with progress bars

```
for _song in track(tracks[:3], description="Converting"):
    time.sleep(0.02)
with Progress() as progress:
    task = progress.add_task("Preparing playlist", total=3)
    for _ in range(3):
        time.sleep(0.02)
        progress.update(task, advance=1)
```

demo07 · rich_progress

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rich Tracebacks

- `install(show_locals=True)` **replaces the uncaught-exception display**
- `console.print_exception` **renders an exception inside an** `except` **block**
- **Locals help identify the input value that failed**

```
install(show_locals=True)
row = {"title": "Imported track", "duration_s": "unknown"}
try:
    duration = int(row["duration_s"])
except ValueError:
    Console().print_exception(show_locals=True, max_frames=2)
```

demo08 · rich_traceback

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rich inspect

- `inspect` displays an object's attributes and values
- `methods=True` adds method signatures
- `help=True` includes documentation

```
class Track:
    def __init__(self, title: str, duration_s: int) -> None:
        self.title: str = title
        self.duration_s: int = duration_s

    def minutes(self) -> float:
        """Return the duration in minutes."""
        return self.duration_s / 60

song = Track("Imagine", 183)
inspect(song, methods=True, help=True)
```

demo09 · rich_inspect

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rich Logging Handler

- `RichHandler` renders messages from the standard `logging` API
- A file handler can also keep a plain log
- `log.exception` includes a traceback for a caught exception

```
logging.basicConfig(level="INFO", format="%(message)s", handlers=[
    RichHandler(rich_tracebacks=True),
    logging.FileHandler(DATA / "player.log", encoding="utf-8"),
])
log = logging.getLogger("player")
log.info(f"PLAY {'Imagine'}")
log.warning(f"Missing local file: {'Yesterday.flac'}")
try:
    int("unknown")
except ValueError:
    log.exception("Invalid imported duration")
```

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HTTP with httpx

- `Client` sends requests and reuses connections
- `MockTransport` supplies responses without a network request
- `raise_for_status` turns error responses into exceptions

```
def example_response(request: httpx.Request) -> httpx.Response:
    return httpx.Response(200, json={"title": "Imagine", "duration_s": 183})

transport = httpx.MockTransport(example_response)
with httpx.Client(transport=transport, timeout=10.0) as client:
    response = client.get("https://example.org/now-playing")
    response.raise_for_status()
    print(response.json())
```

demo11 · httpx_client

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requests and httpx

- `requests` provides a synchronous client and requires an explicit timeout
- `httpx` also supports async clients, HTTP/2 and mock transports
- Both return response objects with status, headers and body data

demo12 · requests_or_httpx

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typer

- `typer` derives arguments, conversions and help from function signatures
- `Annotated` supplies option descriptions
- `@app.command()` registers a function as a subcommand

```python
@app.command("list")
def list_tracks(
    genre: Annotated[str | None, typer.Option("--genre")] = None,
    limit: Annotated[int, typer.Option("--limit")] = 5,
) -> None:
    """List tracks, optionally filtered by genre."""
    show_tracks(genre, limit)
```

demo13 · typer_cli

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typer Trade-offs

- `argparse` is in the standard library; `typer` is a dependency
- Both support positional arguments, options and subcommands
- `typer.Exit(code=...)` sets an exit status
- The playlist `list`, `stats` and `top` commands have the same jobs in both APIs

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Finding Libraries

- PyPI lists Python distributions and their project links
- A dependency declaration records the requested package
- The lockfile records the resolved versions

```
uv add rich
```

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Judging a Library

- Read its documentation, changelog and licence
- Check maintenance activity and dependency requirements
- Installed distribution metadata provides version and project information

```
from importlib import metadata

print(metadata.distribution("rich").version)
```

demo14 · judging_a_library

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Summary : Modern Toolbelt

- Wrap loops with progress displays
- Use `rich` for structured reports and diagnostic detail
- Test HTTP examples with an offline transport
- Build a CLI with annotated functions when using `typer`

Web Scraping

Inheritance
Command-line Programs
Modern Toolbelt
Web Scraping
SQLAlchemy
NumPy
Pandas
GUI Toolkits
APPENDIX Running Other Programs

Web Scraping
Fetching a Page
Status Codes and Timeouts
BeautifulSoup
find and find_all
Text and Attributes
CSS Selectors
Navigating the Tree
Missing Elements
HTML Tables

Extracting Records
SQLite Schema
Parameterised Inserts
SQL Injection
Upsert
Scrape Pipeline
robots.txt and Rate Limiting
Scraping versus an API
Database Handover
Summary : Web Scraping

Web Scraping

- **Every scraper is the same three steps, in the same order :**
  - Fetch, parse, store
- **Each stage has an independent responsibility :**
  - Each step can be tested and re-run without the others
  - Only the middle step knows anything about HTML



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Fetching a Page

- `requests.get` **returns a response object, not a string :**
  - `.text` is the decoded body, `.content` is the raw bytes
- **Two arguments matter far more than the rest :**
  - `timeout`, because there is no default and a hung server hangs you
  - `headers`, to say which program is asking

```
response = requests.get(URL, timeout=10, headers={"User-Agent": "SpiralTrain-Day4/1.0"})
```

demo01 · fetching_pages

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Status Codes and Timeouts

- **The status code is the first thing to check :**
  - `200` fine, `301` and `302` redirects that `requests` follows for you
  - `404` gone, `403` refused, `429` slow down, `5xx` their problem
- `raise_for_status` **turns any** `4xx` **or** `5xx` **into an exception :**
  - Nothing happens for `2xx` and `3xx`, so it is safe to always call
- `response.encoding` **can be set when a page is decoded wrongly**

```
200 OK                    passes, response.ok is True
404 Not Found             raises HTTPError
429 Too Many Requests     raises HTTPError
```

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BeautifulSoup

- `BeautifulSoup` **takes the markup and the name of a parser :**
  - `"lxml"` is fast and forgiving, and is installed for this course
  - `"html.parser"` is built into Python and needs nothing extra
- **The result is a tree you can search, not a string :**
  - Real pages are malformed, and the parser quietly repairs them
- `response.text` **is already decoded, so it goes straight in :**
  - The server declares the encoding, and a price of £51.77 proves it worked

```
soup = BeautifulSoup(html, "lxml")

# Page titles are full of markup whitespace, so collapse it rather than
# trusting what the page hands you.
print(" ".join(soup.title.text.split()))
```

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find and find_all

- `find` **returns the first match, or** `None` **:**
  - `find_all` returns a list, which may be empty
- **Both take a tag name, and keyword arguments for attributes :**
  - `class_` has the underscore because `class` is a Python keyword
- **Searching a tag searches inside that tag only**

```
for article in soup.find_all("article", class_="product_pod"):
    title = article.find("h3").find("a")["title"]
    if title == "Sharp Objects":
        price = article.find("p", class_="price_color").text
        # The page spells the rating as a class name, not a number: markup is
        # written for a browser, not for you.
        stars = article.find("p", class_="star-rating")["class"][1]
        print(f"{RATINGS[stars]}  {price:>8}  {title}")
```

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Text and Attributes

- `.text` **collects every string inside a tag :**
  - `get_text(strip=True)` is the same thing with the whitespace tidied
- **Attributes are read like a dictionary :**
  - `tag["href"]` raises `KeyError` when the attribute is absent
  - `tag.get("href")` returns `None`, or a default you supply
- `class` **comes back as a list, because an element can carry several**

```
stars = pod.find("p", class_="star-rating")
print(stars["class"])              # ['star-rating', 'Four']
print(stars.get("data-value"))     # None, the attribute is not there
```

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CSS Selectors

- `select` and `select_one` take one selector string :
  - The same language a stylesheet or the browser inspector uses
- A whole path through the document fits in one argument :
  - `article.product_pod h3 a` means a inside h3 inside that article
  - `p.star-rating.Four` means both classes on one element

```
print(len(soup.select("article.product_pod h3 a")), "title links")
print(soup.select("article.product_pod h3 a")[1]["title"])

print(soup.select_one("ul.breadcrumb li.active").text.strip())

# Two class names on one element: both, with no space between them.
print(len(soup.select("p.star-rating.Four")), "books rated four")

print(len(soup.select("div.image_container > a > img[alt]")), "thumbnails")
```

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Navigating the Tree

- **Start at something easy to find and move from there :**
  - `.parent` is one step up, `.find_parent("article")` goes up until it matches
  - `.find_next_sibling("p")` skips the whitespace between tags
- **Useful when the thing you want has no class of its own :**
  - A price is easy to find, the module it belongs to is upward from it

```
price = soup.select_one("p.price_color")
print(price.parent.name)

pod = price.find_parent("article")
print(pod.select_one("h3 a")["title"])

print(price.find_next_sibling("p").get_text(strip=True))
```

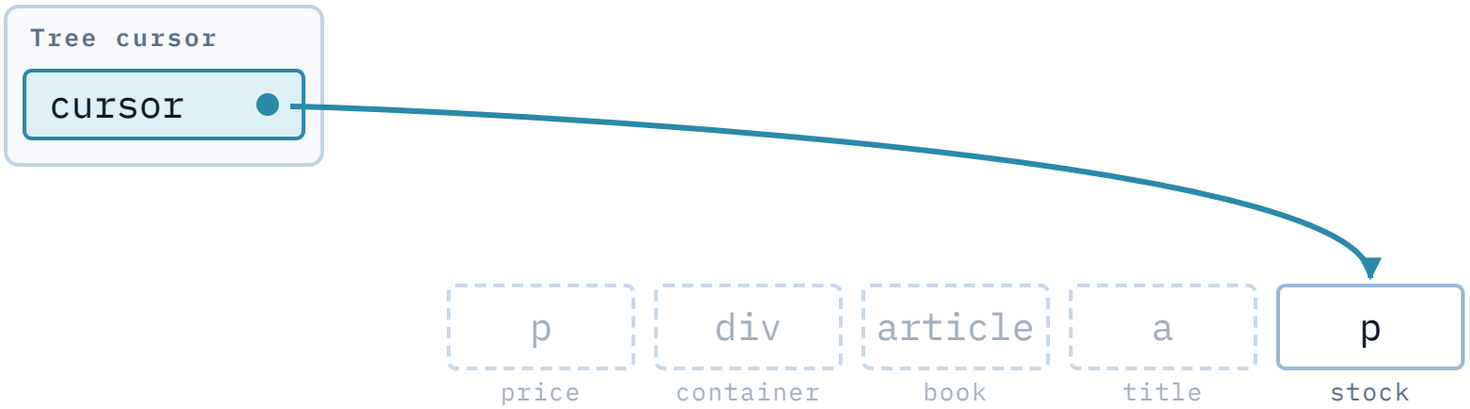
demo05 · walking_the_tree

Traversing a Book Card

```
price = soup.select_one("p.price_color")
print(price.parent.name)

pod = price.find_parent("article")
print(pod.select_one("h3 a")["title"])

print(price.find_next_sibling("p").get_text(strip=True))
```



OUTPUT

```
div
Sharp Objects
In stock
```

find_next_sibling finds the stock paragraph beside the price.

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Missing Elements

- **Real pages are inconsistent, and a scraper meets all of it :**
  - The attribute missing on one row in five hundred
  - The module that has no price because the item is sold out
- **Decide per field what absence means :**
  - `.get("href")` for optional, square brackets for required
  - A required field that is missing should fail loudly, not silently

```
url = link["href"]                          # required, so let it raise
cover = image.get("data-src", "")           # optional, so a default is fine
if pod.find("p", class_="price_color") is None:
    continue                                # no price, no record
```

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HTML Tables

- **A table is the easiest markup to scrape, and the most common :**
  - One header row gives the keys, one body row gives the values
- **`zip(headers, cells, strict=True)` refuses to guess :**
  - A short row raises instead of silently shifting every column

```
headers = [cell.get_text(strip=True) for cell in table.select("tr th")]

rows = []
for row in table.select("tbody tr"):
    cells = [cell.get_text(strip=True) for cell in row.find_all("td")]
    rows.append(dict(zip(headers, cells, strict=True)))
```

demo06 · parsing_a_table

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Extracting Records

- **One function, one page, a list of dictionaries out :**
  - After this line the markup has stopped mattering
- **Convert while parsing, not later :**
  - A price becomes a `float`, a rating becomes an `int`
  - A relative link becomes an absolute one, with `urljoin`

```
soup = BeautifulSoup(html, "lxml")

books = []
for pod in soup.select("article.product_pod"):
    link = pod.select_one("h3 a")
    books.append({
        "title": link["title"],
        "price_gbp": float(re.sub(r"[^\d.]", "", pod.select_one("p.price_color").text)),
        "url": urljoin(URL, link["href"]),
    })
```

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SQLite Schema

- **The same care as any other schema :**
  - One column per field, with a type, and `NOT NULL` where it is true
  - A natural key, `UNIQUE`, so the same page cannot arrive twice
- **`first_seen` and `last_seen` make a re-run informative**

```
CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS books (
    id           INTEGER PRIMARY KEY,
    title        TEXT    NOT NULL,
    price_gbp    REAL    NOT NULL,
    rating       INTEGER NOT NULL,
    url          TEXT    NOT NULL UNIQUE,
    last_seen    TEXT    NOT NULL
);
```

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Parameterised Inserts

- **Placeholders keep the values out of the SQL text :**
  - `?` by position, or `:name` by name
- **Named placeholders take a dictionary as it is :**
  - Which is exactly what the parse step produced
- `executemany` **sends the whole list in one call**

```
conn = sqlite3.connect(DB)
conn.executescript(SCHEMA)
# Named placeholders take the dictionaries exactly as they already are.
conn.executemany(INSERT, books)
conn.commit()
```

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SQL Injection

- **The database is not the only thing that reads the string :**
  - A title containing an apostrophe ends the quoted value early
  - The following text is parsed as SQL
- **One book on the page proves it :**

```
title = "The Bachelor Girl's Guide to Murder"

f"SELECT ... WHERE title = '{title}'"   sqlite3.OperationalError: near "s"
"SELECT ... WHERE title = ?", (title,)  found 1 row
```

- **Parameters keep values separate from the SQL statement**

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Upsert

- **A scrape that only works the first time is not finished :**
  - The job will be re-run, after a crash, or every night
- **`INSERT ... ON CONFLICT DO UPDATE` is one statement for both cases :**
  - `excluded` is the row that was about to be inserted
  - Columns left out of the `SET` keep the value they had

```
INSERT INTO books (title, price_gbp, url, first_seen, last_seen)
VALUES (:title, :price_gbp, :url, :seen_at, :seen_at)
ON CONFLICT(url) DO UPDATE SET
    price_gbp = excluded.price_gbp,
    last_seen = excluded.last_seen
```

demo09 · upsert

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Scrape Pipeline

- **One script, read top to bottom, in four labelled sections :**
  - Fetch the page, parse the records, store them, report on the table
- **Nothing is wrapped in a function it does not need :**
  - The whole file is the pipeline, and the order on screen is the order it runs
- **Running it a second time changes `last_seen` and nothing else**

```
uv run demos/04-web-scraping/10_scrape_pipeline.py
```

demo10 · scrape_pipeline

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robots.txt and Rate Limiting

- `robots.txt` describes which paths a crawler may request.
- `RobotFileParser` reads the rules; this example uses saved text.

```
from urllib.robotparser import RobotFileParser

ROBOTS = "User-agent: *\nDisallow: /basket/\nCrawl-delay: 5\n"
AGENT = "TrainingDemo/1.0"
url = "https://books.toscrape.com/basket/"
rules = RobotFileParser()
rules.parse(ROBOTS.splitlines())
print(rules.can_fetch(AGENT, url))  # False
print(rules.crawl_delay(AGENT))  # 5
```

- Identify the scraper with a `User-Agent` and contact details.
- Respect the site's rules, pause between requests and reuse cached pages.

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Scraping versus an API

- **Scraping is the last resort, not the first :**
  - An API returns JSON that does not change when the design does
  - A CSV or data export is better still, and often already there
- **Signs it is time to stop :**
  - The page builds itself with JavaScript, so the markup is empty
  - There is a login, a CAPTCHA, or a rate limit aimed at you
  - The markup changes weekly and the parser breaks weekly
- **Look for `/api/`, an RSS feed, or a documented download first**

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Database Handover

- **The database is the handover point :**
  - Pandas reads it back with `read_sql`
  - A GUI can put a window on the same table
- **A checked in `.sql` file rebuilds it without the scraper :**
  - So the later blocks work even if nothing was ever scraped

```
conn = sqlite3.connect(DB)
conn.executescript((DATA / "books-seed.sql").read_text(encoding="utf-8"))
conn.commit()
```

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Summary : Web Scraping

- Fetch, parse and store live in separate functions
- Every request has a timeout and a `User-Agent`
- Parsing is a separate step, so it can be re-run without re-fetching
- Values are converted at the parse step, not at the database
- Inserts are parameterised, and the re-run is an upsert
- The pace respects `robots.txt`, and the log says who you are

SQLAlchemy

Inheritance
Command-line Programs
Modern Toolbelt
Web Scraping
SQLAlchemy
NumPy
Pandas
GUI Toolkits
APPENDIX Running Other Programs

SQLAlchemy
sqlite3 and SQLAlchemy
Engine and URL
begin and connect
Bound Parameters
Table Definitions
Core Queries
Declarative Models

Session
ORM Queries
Relationships
Joins and Relationships
Reflection
SQLAlchemy and Pandas
text, Core and ORM
Summary : SQLAlchemy

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SQLAlchemy

- **The scraping module talked to SQLite with `sqlite3` :**
  - Which is the driver, and drivers are database-specific
- **SQLAlchemy sits above the driver :**
  - One way of working, whichever database is underneath
- **It has two halves, and both are useful :**
  - `Core`, which builds SQL out of Python objects
  - The `ORM`, which maps rows onto classes
- **Nothing here replaces knowing SQL :**
  - It repays knowing SQL, which is the point

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sqlite3 and SQLAlchemy

- **The same call, against a different database :**
  - Change the URL, not the program
- **Parameters have names instead of positions**
- **Rows can come back as objects rather than tuples**
- **The query is a value you can build up, print and reuse**

```
found = connection.execute(
    text("SELECT title, price FROM book WHERE price > :floor"), {"floor": 25}
)
print("sqlalchemy :", found.all())
```

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Engine and URL

- **An engine is a factory and a connection pool :**
  - Make one per database, once, and keep it
  - It does not open a connection until something asks
- **The URL says everything about where the data lives :**

```
dialect+driver://user:password@host/database

sqlite:///:memory:
sqlite:///data/library.db
postgresql+psycopg://feiko@localhost/inventory
```

- **SQLite needs no server, so the middle of the URL is empty**

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begin and connect

- `engine.begin()` **opens a transaction :**
  - Commits when the module ends, rolls back if it raises
- `engine.connect()` **gives you a connection and nothing else :**
  - Anything written is discarded unless you commit it yourself
- **Prefer** `begin()` **for anything that writes**

```
with engine.begin() as connection:
    connection.execute(text("INSERT INTO note VALUES ('kept')"))

with engine.connect() as connection:
    rows = connection.execute(text("SELECT body FROM note")).scalars().all()
```

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Bound Parameters

- **The parameter is sent separately from the statement :**
  - The database never parses the value as SQL
- **Named, so there are no question marks to count**
- **The scraping module uses the same separation of SQL and values**

```
statement = text("SELECT title FROM book WHERE rating >= :floor")
connection.execute(statement, {"floor": 3})
```

- **A formatted query breaks on ordinary data long before it is attacked :**

```
SELECT rating FROM book WHERE title = 'The Widow's Tale'
```

Table Definitions

- **Core describes a table as a Python object :**
  - Columns, types, constraints, all as values
- **`MetaData` is the catalogue every table registers in**
- **`create_all()` issues `CREATE TABLE` for whatever is missing**

```
book = Table(
    "book",
    metadata,
    Column("id", Integer, primary_key=True),
    Column("title", String(200), nullable=False),
    Column("price_gbp", Float, nullable=False),
)
```

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Core Queries

- `select()` **returns something you can hold, print and add to :**
  - `.where()`, `.order_by()`, `.limit()` each return a new query
- **Column access is** `table.c.name`
- **Printing the query shows the SQL it will send**

```
statement = select(book.c.title, book.c.price_gbp).where(book.c.rating >= 4)
print(statement)

with engine.connect() as connection:
    for title, price in connection.execute(statement):
        print(f"{title:<24} {price:>6.2f}")
```

demo05 · core_insert_and_select

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Declarative Models

- **The ORM maps a class onto a table :**
  - One class, one table, one instance per row
- **Every model inherits from a `DeclarativeBase` :**
  - Which is block one doing real work
- **`Mapped[int]` is an ordinary annotation, so editors understand it**

```
class Book(Base):
    __tablename__ = "book"

    id: Mapped[int] = mapped_column(Integer, primary_key=True)
    title: Mapped[str] = mapped_column(String(200))
    price_gbp: Mapped[float] = mapped_column(Float)
```

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Session

- A `Session` is a unit of work, not a connection :
  - Add objects to it, then commit once
- Generated ids become available when inserts are flushed
- The session tracks what it loaded :
  - Change an attribute and there is no `UPDATE` to write
- `flush()` sends pending writes inside the current transaction
- `commit()` makes the transaction permanent

```
with Session(engine) as session:
    session.add_all([first, second])
    session.flush()
    session.commit()

    first.price_gbp = 41.99
    session.commit()
```

A Book Through a Transaction

```python
with Session(engine) as session:
    first = Book(title="Sharp Objects", price_gbp=47.82, rating=4)
    second = Book(title="In a Dark, Dark Wood", price_gbp=19.63, rating=1)
    session.add_all([first, second])
    print(first.id, second.id)

    session.flush()
    print(first.id, second.id)

    # Flush assigns ids inside the transaction; commit makes the writes permanent.
    session.commit()
    print(first.id, second.id)
```

OUTPUT

```
None None
1 2
1 2
```

Committed — book

title	Sharp Objects
id	1

Commit makes the transaction permanent.

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ORM Queries

- The same `select()`, but the rows are objects
- `scalars()` unwraps a one-column result into the thing itself
- Comparisons build SQL rather than returning a boolean :
  - `Book.rating >= 4` is a fragment of a `WHERE` clause

```
for found in session.scalars(select(Book).where(Book.rating >= 4)):
    print(found)
```

```
for rating, count, mean in session.execute(
    select(Book.rating, func.count(), func.avg(Book.price_gbp)).group_by(Book.rating)
):
    print(f"{rating}* {count:>3} {mean:>8.2f}")
```

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Relationships

- **A foreign key becomes an attribute on both sides :**
  - `category.books` is a list, `book.category` is an object
- `back_populates` **names the attribute pointing the other way**
- **Appending to the list is what creates the link :**
  - No ids written by hand, and the insert order is worked out

```
class Category(Base):
    books: Mapped[list[Book]] = relationship(back_populates="category")

mystery.books.append(Book(title="Sharp Objects"))
session.add(mystery)
```

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Joins and Relationships

- **As a join :**
  - One query
  - Explicit, and familiar
  - What the database does anyway

```
joined = select(Book.title, Category.name).join(Book.category)
print(joined)
for title, category in session.execute(joined):
    print(f"{title:<18} {category}")

for found in session.scalars(select(Book)):
    print(f"{found.title:<18} {found.category.name}")
```

- **As an attribute :**
  - Reads better
  - Issues a query per object
  - Easy to do by accident

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Reflection

- **Reflection reads the schema out of an existing database :**
  - Rather than describing it in Python first
- **Which is most databases, most of the time**

```
metadata = MetaData()
metadata.reflect(bind=engine)

books = metadata.tables["books"]
print([column.name for column in books.columns])
```

- **The demo points at the database the scraping module filled in**

demo11 · reading_the_scraped_db

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SQLAlchemy and Pandas

- `read_sql` **takes an engine anywhere it takes a connection :**
  - So the portable half comes along for free
- **The grouping can happen in either place :**
  - In the database, or in the DataFrame afterwards
- **For twenty rows it makes no difference :**
  - For twenty million, let the database do it

```
engine = create_engine(f"sqlite:///{DB}")
frame = pd.read_sql("SELECT title, price_gbp, rating FROM books", engine)
```

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text, Core and ORM

- **`text()` when the SQL is the clearest way to say it :**
  - Or when it is already written and correct
- **`Core` when the query is assembled from parts, or must be portable**
- **The `ORM` when rows are things the program keeps hold of and changes**
- **These are not levels, and not a progression :**
  - Plenty of good programs use all three in one file

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Summary : SQLAlchemy

- SQLAlchemy sits above the driver, not above SQL
- An engine is made once and carries the URL :
  - Use `begin()` for anything that writes
- Core builds queries as objects you can print and compose
- The ORM maps a class onto a table, with a `Session` as the unit of work
- Relationships turn a foreign key into an attribute on both sides
- Reflection reads a schema somebody else designed
- An engine drops straight into `pandas.read_sql`

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NumPy

Inheritance
Command-line Programs
Modern Toolbelt
Web Scraping
SQLAlchemy
NumPy
Pandas
GUI Toolkits
APPENDIX Running Other Programs

NumPy Arrays
Memory Use
Speed
Creating Arrays
Array Data Types
Shape and Dimensions
Reshaping and Transposing
Indexing and Slicing
Views and Copies

Vectorised Arithmetic
Boolean Masking
np.where
Broadcasting
Aggregations
axis Argument
Random Numbers
Reading a CSV
Summary : NumPy

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NumPy Arrays

- An array holds values of one dtype in a regular shape
- Arithmetic applies to every element without a Python loop
- `np.sin` can compute samples of an audio tone

```
times = np.arange(8) / 8000
samples = np.sin(2 * np.pi * 440 * times)
print(samples.round(3))
print(samples * 0.5)
```

demo01 · first_array

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Memory Use

- A Python list holds references to Python objects
- A numeric array stores the numbers in a contiguous buffer
- `nbytes` measures the array buffer; `getsizeof` measures Python objects

```
count = 60 * 44100
samples = [math.sin(2 * math.pi * 440 * i / 44100) for i in range(count)]
tone = np.array(samples)
list_bytes = sys.getsizeof(samples) + sum(sys.getsizeof(x) for x in samples)
print(f"list: {list_bytes:,} bytes")
print(f"array: {tone.nbytes:,} bytes")
```

demo02 · memory_footprint

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Speed

- NumPy evaluates array arithmetic in compiled code
- A Python loop evaluates one sample at a time
- Compare equivalent results before comparing elapsed time

```
count = 60 * 44100
start = time.perf_counter()
samples = [math.sin(2 * math.pi * 440 * i / 44100) for i in range(count)]
print(f"Python: {time.perf_counter() - start:.3f} s")
start = time.perf_counter()
times = np.arange(count) / 44100
tone = np.sin(2 * np.pi * 440 * times)
print(f"NumPy: {time.perf_counter() - start:.3f} s")
print(np.allclose(samples, tone))
```

demo03 · speed_comparison

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Creating Arrays

- `array` converts an existing sequence
- `arange` selects a step; `linspace` selects a sample count
- `zeros`, `ones` and `full` fill a given shape

```
print(np.array([183, 126, 146]))
print(np.arange(0, 8, 2))
print(np.linspace(0.0, 1.0, 5))
print(np.zeros((2, 4)))
print(np.ones(3, dtype=int))
print(np.full(3, 0.5))
```

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Array Data Types

- `dtype` determines the representation of each element
- Request a dtype at construction or convert with `astype`
- Integer conversions discard fractional parts; narrow integers have limits

```
samples = np.array([0.1, 0.5, -0.4], dtype=np.float32)
print(samples.dtype)
print(samples.astype(np.int16))
print(np.iinfo(np.int16).min, np.iinfo(np.int16).max)
counts = np.array([183, 126, 146], dtype=np.int64)
print(counts.dtype, counts.itemsize)
```

demo05 · dtypes

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Shape and Dimensions

- An RGB image has height, width and colour-channel dimensions
- `.shape` gives each dimension's length; `.ndim` counts dimensions
- `.size` counts all elements

```
print(photo.shape)
print(photo.ndim)
print(photo.size)
print(photo[0, 0].shape)
```

demo06 · shape_and_ndim

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Reshaping and Transposing

- `reshape` changes dimensions while preserving the element count
- `-1` asks NumPy to calculate one dimension
- `transpose` rearranges axes; `.T` reverses them

```
pixels = photo.reshape(-1, 3)
print(pixels.shape)
print(np.shares_memory(pixels, photo))
print(photo.transpose(1, 0, 2).shape)
print(pixels.T.shape)
```

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Indexing and Slicing

- Give one index or slice per dimension, separated by commas
- A slice excludes its stop position
- A negative step reverses an axis

```
print(photo[24, 32])
crop = photo[12:36, 16:48]
print(crop.shape)
flipped = photo[::-1]
print(np.array_equal(flipped[0], photo[-1]))
print(photo[:, :, 0].shape)
```

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Views and Copies

- Basic slicing returns a view of the same buffer
- Writing through a view also changes the original
- `.copy()` makes an independent buffer; advanced indexing also copies

```
crop = photo[12:36, 16:48]
detached = crop.copy()
crop[0, 0] = [1.0, 0.0, 0.0]
print(photo[12, 16])
print(detached[0, 0])
print(np.shares_memory(crop, photo))
print(np.shares_memory(detached, photo))
print(np.shares_memory(photo[[0, 1]], photo))
```

A View Shares the Photo Buffer

```
crop = photo[12:36, 16:48]
detached = crop.copy()
crop[0, 0] = [1.0, 0.0, 0.0]
print(photo[12, 16])
print(detached[0, 0])
print(np.shares_memory(crop, photo))
print(np.shares_memory(detached, photo))
print(np.shares_memory(photo[[0, 1]], photo))
```

OUTPUT

```
[1. 0. 0.]
[0.50980395 0.5254902  0.7019608 ]
True
False
False
```

photo red channel

	16	17	18
12	**1**	0.58	0.447
13	0.353	0.651	0.773

crop red channel

	0	1	2
0	**1**	0.58	0.447
1	0.353	0.651	0.773

copy red channel

	0	1	2
0	**0.51**	0.58	0.447
1	0.353	0.651	0.773

Advanced indexing also creates a copy.

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Vectorised Arithmetic

- A scalar applies to every element
- Matching shapes combine element by element
- Functions such as `sqrt`, `sin` and `log10` also accept arrays

```
times = np.arange(8) / 8000
tone = np.sin(2 * np.pi * 440 * times)
quiet = tone * 0.5
print(quiet.round(3))
print(np.sqrt(tone ** 2).round(3))
print((tone - quiet).round(3))
```

demo10 · vectorised_arithmetic

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Boolean Masking

- A comparison creates an array of booleans
- Indexing with a mask keeps matching values
- `&` and `|` combine conditions; each comparison needs parentheses

```
tone = np.array([0.0, 0.2, 0.9, -0.8, 0.0, -0.1])
silent = np.abs(tone) < 0.05
print(tone[silent])
print(silent.sum(), silent.any(), silent.all())
print(np.nonzero(silent)[0])
print(tone[(tone > -0.5) & (tone < 0.5)])
```

demo11 · boolean_masking

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np.where

- `where(condition, yes, no)` chooses a value for each element
- Each branch can be an array or a scalar
- Nesting a second `where` supports three outcomes

```
tone = np.array([-0.9, -0.2, 0.0, 0.4, 0.9])
clipped = np.where(tone > 0.5, 0.5, np.where(tone < -0.5, -0.5, tone))
print(clipped)
print(np.where(np.abs(tone) < 0.05, "silence", "sound"))
print(np.where(tone > 0.5)[0])
```

demo12 · np_where

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Broadcasting

- Shapes align from the right
- Dimensions must be equal or one of them must be `1`
- Three channel factors apply to every pixel in an RGB photo

```
factors = np.array([1.1, 1.0, 0.9])
corrected = np.clip(photo * factors, 0.0, 1.0)
print(photo.shape, factors.shape, corrected.shape)
print(np.broadcast_shapes((48, 64, 3), (3,)))
print(np.broadcast_shapes((3, 1), (4,)))
```

Three Factors for Every Pixel

```
factors = np.array([1.1, 1.0, 0.9])
corrected = np.clip(photo * factors, 0.0, 1.0)
print(photo.shape, factors.shape, corrected.shape)
print(np.broadcast_shapes((48, 64, 3), (3,)))
```

Shapes align from the right

	height	width	channels
photo	48	64	**3**
factors			**3**
result	48	64	**3**

Channel multipliers

	red	green	blue
factor	1.1	1	0.9

OUTPUT

```
(48, 64, 3) (3,) (48, 64, 3)
(48, 64, 3)
```

broadcast_shapes confirms the compatible result shape.

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Aggregations

- Reductions produce totals, averages or extreme values
- `argmax` gives a position; `unravel_index` converts it to coordinates
- Median and percentiles describe the distribution

```
print(plays.sum(), plays.mean().round(2))
print(plays.min(), plays.max(), plays.std().round(2))
print(np.median(plays), np.percentile(plays, 95))
day, hour = np.unravel_index(np.argmax(plays), plays.shape)
print(f"peak: day {day}, hour {hour:02d}")
```

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axis Argument

- `axis` names the dimension removed by the reduction
- A days-by-hours grid reduces to hours with `axis=0`
- `axis=1` removes the hours and leaves a value per day
- `keepdims=True` retains the reduced dimension with length one

```
plays = np.array([[1, 2, 3, 4], [2, 0, 1, 3], [0, 1, 2, 1]])
print(plays.sum())
print(plays.sum(axis=0))
print(plays.sum(axis=1))
print(plays.sum(axis=1, keepdims=True).shape)
```

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Reducing Days and Hours

```
plays = np.array([[1, 2, 3, 4], [2, 0, 1, 3], [0, 1, 2, 1]])
print(plays.sum())
print(plays.sum(axis=0))
print(plays.sum(axis=1))
print(plays.sum(axis=1, keepdims=True).shape)
```

OUTPUT

```
20
[3 3 6 8]
[10  6  4]
(3, 1)
```

Days by hours

	08	09	10	11
Mon	1	2	3	4
Tue	2	0	1	3
Wed	0	1	2	1

axis=0 removes days

	08	09	10	11
sum	3	3	6	8

axis=1 removes hours

	sum
Mon	10
Tue	6
Wed	4

keepdims retains a size-one column dimension.

demo15 · the_axis_argument

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Random Numbers

- `default_rng(seed)` produces reproducible pseudorandom draws
- `choice` samples existing values; `permutation` returns a shuffled copy
- `shuffle` changes its input in place

```
rng = np.random.default_rng(7)
titles = np.array(["Imagine", "Yesterday", "Respect", "Toxic"])
print(rng.permutation(titles))
print(rng.choice(titles, size=2, replace=False))
print(rng.integers(0, 10, size=4))
print(rng.random(3).round(2))
print(rng.normal(0.0, 0.1, size=3).round(2))
rng.shuffle(titles)
print(titles)
```

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Reading a CSV

- `loadtxt` reads regular numeric data
- `skiprows` excludes the header; `usecols` excludes the day labels
- `savetxt` writes an array back to a file

```
print(plays.shape)
print(plays.sum(axis=0))
print(plays.sum(axis=1))
print(int(np.argmax(plays.sum(axis=0))))
np.savetxt(DATA / "plays-hourly-mean.csv", plays.mean(axis=0),
           delimiter=",", fmt="%.2f")
```

demo17 · csv_into_array

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Summary : NumPy

- Arrays have a dtype and a regular shape
- Slices usually share memory; copies own independent buffers
- Arithmetic, masks and `where` operate on whole arrays
- Broadcasting aligns compatible dimensions from the right
- Reductions remove the selected axes; seeded generators repeat their draws

Pandas

- Inheritance
- Command-line Programs
- Modern Toolbelt
- Web Scraping
- SQLAlchemy
- NumPy
- **Pandas**
- GUI Toolkits
- APPENDIX Running Other Programs

- Pandas
- Series
- DataFrame
- The Index
- Reading a CSV
- Reading a Spreadsheet
- head and tail
- info and describe
- Selecting Columns
- loc
- iloc
- loc and iloc
- Filtering Rows
- Combining Filters

- Adding a Column
- Deriving a Column
- Sorting
- groupby
- groupby Aggregation
- Named Aggregation
- merge
- Join Types
- Missing Values
- read_sql
- to_sql
- Writing Files
- Plotting
- Summary : Pandas

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Pandas

- `pandas` **works with labelled tables :**
  - `Series` represents a column; `DataFrame` represents a table
- **CSV files, spreadsheets and query results share the same operations**
- **Column operations use NumPy arrays and other array implementations**
- **A typical report reads, inspects, filters, summarises and exports data**

```
import pandas as pd
```

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Series

- A `Series` has one index label per value
- Arithmetic and comparisons apply to every value
- `.index` gives the labels; `.to_numpy()` gives the values

```
durations = pd.Series([183, 126, 146],
                      index=["Imagine", "Yesterday", "Respect"])
print(durations["Imagine"])
print(durations / 60)
print(durations > 180)
print(durations.index.tolist())
print(durations.to_numpy())
```

demo01 · series_basics

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DataFrame

- A `DataFrame` has named columns with independent types
- A dictionary supplies one list per column
- `.shape` gives rows and columns; `.columns` gives their names

```
tracks = pd.DataFrame({
    "title": ["Imagine", "Yesterday", "Respect"],
    "artist": ["John Lennon", "The Beatles", "Aretha Franklin"],
    "duration_s": [183, 126, 146],
})
print(tracks)
print(tracks.shape)
print(tracks["duration_s"])
```

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The Index

- `set_index` promotes a column to row labels
- Filtering and sorting retain the labels
- Arithmetic aligns matching labels even when their positions differ

```
by_title = tracks.set_index("title")
print(by_title.loc["Imagine", ["artist", "duration_s"]])
durations = pd.Series([183, 126], index=["Imagine", "Yesterday"])
limits = pd.Series([180, 240], index=["Yesterday", "Imagine"])
print(limits - durations)
```

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Reading a CSV

- `read_csv` infers column types from the file
- Useful options select a delimiter, columns and row labels :
  - `sep=`, `usecols=`, `index_col=`
- `parse_dates=` converts named date columns; `na_values=` adds missing-value markers

```
tracks = pd.read_csv(DATA / "tracks.csv", index_col="title",
                     parse_dates=["last_played"])
print(tracks[["artist", "duration_s", "last_played"]].head(3))
```

demo04 · read_csv

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Reading a Spreadsheet

- `read_excel` reads a sheet into a `DataFrame`
- `sheet_name=` selects the sheet by name or position
- `ExcelFile(...).sheet_names` lists the available sheets

```
tracks = pd.read_excel(DATA / "tracks.xlsx", sheet_name="tracks")
print(pd.ExcelFile(DATA / "tracks.xlsx").sheet_names)
print(tracks[["title", "genre", "plays"]].head(3))
```

demo05 · read_excel

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head and tail

- `head(n)` and `tail(n)` select rows at either end
- `sample(n, random_state=...)` gives a reproducible sample
- A sample can reveal values that the first rows do not contain

```
print(tracks[["genre", "plays"]].head(2))
print(tracks[["genre", "plays"]].tail(2))
print(tracks[["genre", "plays"]].sample(3, random_state=0))
```

demo06 · head_and_tail

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info and describe

- `info()` **reports names, dtypes and non-missing counts**
- `describe()` **summarises numeric columns :**
  - Count, mean, standard deviation, quartiles and range
- **Date parsing changes a text column into a datetime dtype**

```
tracks.info()
print(tracks[["duration_s", "plays"]].describe().round(1))
```

demo07 · info_and_describe

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Selecting Columns

- A column name selects a `Series`
- A list of column names selects a `DataFrame`
- The list also determines the report column order

```
print(tracks["plays"].head(3))
print(tracks[["plays"]].head(3))
print(tracks[["genre", "artist", "duration_s"]].head(3))
```

demo08 · selecting_columns

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loc

- `loc[rows, columns]` **selects by labels :**
  - One label, a list of labels, or a label slice
- **Label slices include both ends**

```
print(tracks.loc["Imagine", "duration_s"])
print(tracks.loc["Imagine", ["artist", "genre"]])
print(tracks.loc["Imagine":"Respect", "year":"plays"])
print(tracks.loc[:, ["genre", "plays"]].head(3))
```

demo09 · loc_by_label

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iloc

- `iloc[rows, columns]` selects by integer positions
- Integer slices exclude the stop position
- Moving rows changes what an integer position selects

```
print(tracks.iloc[0, 3])
print(tracks.iloc[:3, :2])
print(tracks.iloc[-2:, :2])
print(tracks.iloc[[0, 5, 2], [0, 1]])
```

demo10 · iloc_by_position

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loc and iloc

- `loc` uses labels and includes the slice endpoint
- `iloc` uses zero-based positions and excludes the endpoint
- Both put rows before columns
- Plain `frame[...]` selects columns; a boolean mask selects rows

```
print(tracks.loc["Imagine", "duration_s"])
print(tracks.iloc[0, 3])
```

Labels and Positions

```
frame = tracks.iloc[:3][["genre", "plays"]]
print(frame.loc["Yesterday", "plays"])
print(frame.iloc[0, 1])
print(frame.loc["Imagine":"Yesterday", ["plays"]])
```

OUTPUT

```
28
11
           plays
title
Imagine       11
Yesterday     28
```

Same table, two selectors

	genre	plays
Imagine	Rock	**11**
Yesterday	Rock	**28**
Respect	Soul	45

The label slice includes both Imagine and Yesterday.

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Filtering Rows

- A column comparison produces a boolean `Series`
- Indexing with that mask keeps rows where it is `True`
- Summing a mask counts matching rows

```
popular = tracks["plays"] >= 50
print(tracks[popular][["genre", "plays"]].head(4))
print(int(popular.sum()))
print(tracks[tracks["genre"] == "Soul"][["plays"]])
```

demo11 · boolean_filter

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Combining Filters

- `&`, `|` and `~` combine boolean masks
- Each comparison needs parentheses
- `isin` checks membership; `between` checks an inclusive interval

```
mask = (tracks["plays"] >= 50) & (tracks["duration_s"] < 240)
print(tracks[mask][["duration_s", "plays"]].head(4))
print(tracks[tracks["genre"].isin(["Soul", "Country"])][["genre"]].head(4))
print(tracks[tracks["year"].between(1980, 1999)][["year"]].head(4))
print(tracks[~tracks["genre"].isin(["Rock", "Pop"])][["genre"]].head(4))
```

demo12 · combining_filters

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Adding a Column

- Assigning a new column name creates the column
- A scalar applies to every row; a computed `Series` aligns by index
- `assign` returns a new frame; `drop(columns=...)` removes columns

```
tracks["available"] = True
tracks["listened_s"] = tracks["duration_s"] * tracks["plays"]
report = tracks.assign(minutes=tracks["listened_s"] / 60)
print(report[["plays", "minutes"]].head(3).round(1))
print(tracks.drop(columns=["available"]).columns.tolist())
```

demo13 · adding_columns

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Deriving a Column

- `.str` applies string operations down a column
- `.map(dictionary)` translates values to labels
- `np.where` chooses between values for each row

```
tracks["initial"] = tracks["artist"].str.upper().str[:1]
tracks["style"] = tracks["genre"].map({"Rock": "guitar", "Pop": "vocal"})
tracks["status"] = np.where(tracks["plays"] > 50, "favourite", "occasional")
tracks.loc[tracks["last_played"].isna(), "status"] = "never"
print(tracks[["initial", "style", "status"]].head(6))
```

demo14 · deriving_columns

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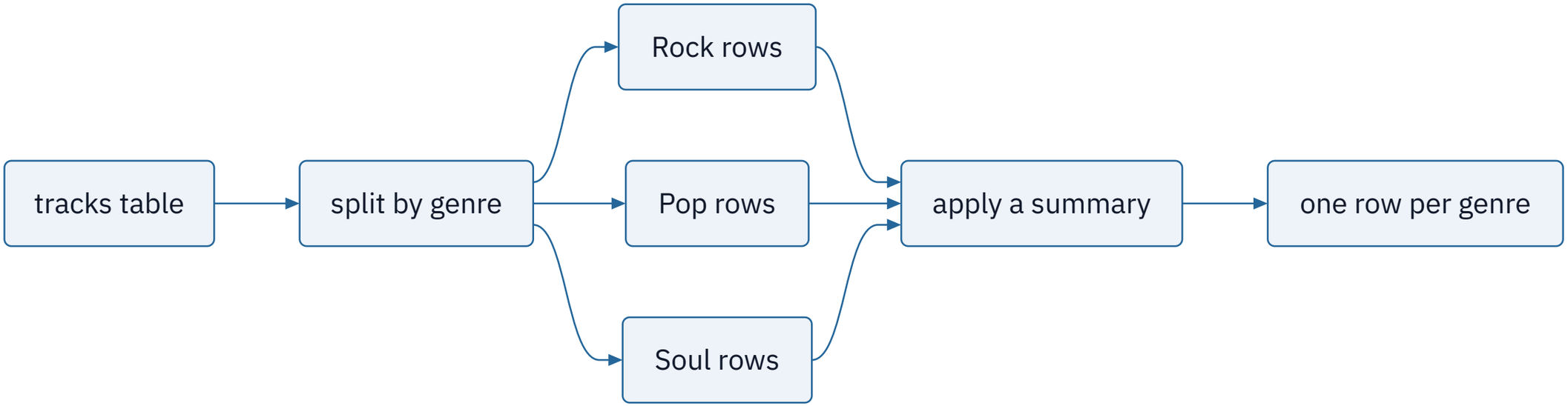
Sorting

- `sort_values` takes one column or a list of columns
- `ascending` accepts one boolean or a boolean per column
- `nlargest` and `nsmallest` select extreme rows; `sort_index` orders labels

```
print(tracks.sort_values("plays", ascending=False)[["plays"]].head(3))
print(tracks.sort_values(["genre", "plays"], ascending=[True, False])
      [["genre", "plays"]].head(4))
print(tracks.nlargest(3, "plays")[["plays"]])
print(tracks.nsmallest(2, "duration_s")[["duration_s"]])
print(tracks.sort_index()[["plays"]].head(2))
```

demo15 · sort_values

groupby



- **Each distinct grouping value produces one summary row**

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Summing Each Genre

```
sample = tracks.iloc[:3][["genre", "plays"]]
groups = sample.groupby("genre")
totals = groups["plays"].sum()
print(totals)
```

OUTPUT

```
genre
Rock    39
Soul    45
Name: plays, dtype: int64
```

Input tracks

	genre	plays
Imagine	**Rock**	11
Yesterday	**Rock**	28
Respect	**Soul**	45

One sum per genre

	plays
Rock	39
Soul	45

The result has one indexed value per genre.

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groupby Aggregation

- Select the grouping column, then the values and summary
- `agg` accepts a list of summaries or a dictionary per column
- The group label becomes the result index

```
print(tracks.groupby("genre")["plays"].sum())
print(tracks.groupby("genre")["duration_s"].mean().round(1))
print(tracks.groupby("genre").size())
print(tracks.groupby("genre")["plays"].agg(["count", "sum", "mean", "max"]))
print(tracks.groupby("genre").agg({"plays": "sum", "year": "min"}))
```

demo16 · groupby_agg

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Named Aggregation

- Each keyword names a result column
- Its value is `(source_column, summary)`
- `reset_index()` restores grouping labels as ordinary columns

```
per_genre = tracks.groupby("genre").agg(
    titles=("artist", "count"),
    total_plays=("plays", "sum"),
    mean_duration=("duration_s", "mean"),
).round(1).reset_index()
print(per_genre)
tracks["decade"] = tracks["year"] // 10 * 10
print(tracks.groupby(["genre", "decade"])["plays"].sum())
```

demo17 · groupby_named_agg

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merge

- `merge` combines frames on a shared key
- `on` names the shared column
- `left_on` and `right_on` support different key names

```
artists = pd.read_csv(DATA / "artists.csv")
joined = tracks.merge(artists, on="artist")
print(joined[["title", "artist", "country"]].head(3))
print(joined.groupby("country")["plays"].sum())
```

demo18 · merge_on_key

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Join Types

- `inner` keeps matching keys; `left` keeps every left row
- `right` keeps every right row; `outer` keeps both sides
- `indicator=True` records `both`, `left_only` or `right_only`

```
artists = pd.read_csv(DATA / "artists.csv")
for how in ("inner", "left", "right", "outer"):
    merged = tracks.merge(artists, on="artist", how=how)
    print(f"{how}: {len(merged)} rows")
outer = tracks.merge(artists, on="artist", how="outer", indicator=True)
print(outer.loc[outer["_merge"] != "both", ["title", "artist", "_merge"]])
```

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Keeping Unmatched Artists

```
inner = tracks.merge(artists, on="artist", how="inner")
print(len(inner))
left = tracks.merge(artists, on="artist", how="left")
print(len(left))
right = tracks.merge(artists, on="artist", how="right")
print(len(right))
outer = tracks.merge(artists, on="artist", how="outer")
print(len(outer))
```

OUTPUT

```
2
3
3
4
```

Input keys

	track title	country
John Lennon	Imagine	**NA**
The Beatles	Yesterday	UK
Aretha Franklin	Respect	USA
Fleetwood Mac	**NA**	UK

Join result

	country
Respect	USA
NA	UK
Imagine	NA
Yesterday	UK

The outer join has four rows.

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Missing Values

- `isna` recognises missing values; summing its mask counts them
- `dropna(subset=...)` removes rows missing selected columns
- `fillna` replaces missing values explicitly
- Summaries generally skip missing values

```
print(tracks.isna().sum())
print(tracks.loc[tracks["last_played"].isna(), ["artist", "last_played"]])
print(len(tracks.dropna(subset=["last_played"])))
filled = tracks.fillna({"last_played": "never"})
print(filled.loc["Hey Jude", "last_played"])
```

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read_sql

- `read_sql` returns a query result as a `DataFrame`
- A `sqlite3` connection can read the scraping module's books database
- Query parameters keep values separate from SQL

```
query = "SELECT title, price_gbp, rating FROM books WHERE price_gbp > ? ORDER BY price_gbp DESC"
print(pd.read_sql(query, conn, params=(45.0,)).to_string())
```

demo21 · read_sql

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to_sql

- `to_sql` writes a frame to a database table
- `if_exists` selects `fail`, `replace` or `append`
- `index=False` excludes row labels from the stored table

```
conn = sqlite3.connect(DATA / "pandas-demo.db")
books = pd.read_csv(DATA / "books-sample.csv")
summary = books.groupby("rating", as_index=False)["price_gbp"].mean()
summary.to_sql("rating_summary", conn, if_exists="replace", index=False)
conn.commit()
print(pd.read_sql("SELECT * FROM rating_summary", conn))
conn.close()
```

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Writing Files

- `to_csv` and `to_excel` export frames
- `index=False` excludes row labels when they are not report data
- `ExcelWriter` writes several sheets into one workbook

```
report = tracks.reset_index().sort_values("plays", ascending=False)
report.to_csv(DATA / "tracks-report.csv", index=False)
report.to_csv(DATA / "tracks-report.tsv", sep="\t", index=False)
per_genre = tracks.groupby("genre", as_index=False)["plays"].sum()
with pd.ExcelWriter(DATA / "tracks-report.xlsx", engine="openpyxl") as workbook:
    report.to_excel(workbook, sheet_name="tracks", index=False)
    per_genre.to_excel(workbook, sheet_name="per genre", index=False)
print(pd.ExcelFile(DATA / "tracks-report.xlsx").sheet_names)
```

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Plotting

- `.plot(kind=...)` draws a frame or column
- The `Agg` backend writes files without opening a window
- `get_figure().savefig(...)` saves the resulting chart

```
tracks["decade"] = tracks["year"] // 10 * 10
per_decade = tracks.groupby("decade")["plays"].sum()
axes = per_decade.plot(kind="bar", title="Fictional plays by decade")
axes.set_ylabel("plays")
axes.get_figure().tight_layout()
axes.get_figure().savefig(DATA / "tracks-plot.png", dpi=120)
plt.close(axes.get_figure())
print(per_decade)
```

demo24 · plot_to_file

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Summary : Pandas

- `Series` and `DataFrame` attach labels to data
- Read CSV, Excel and SQL; inspect structure and missing values
- Select by label with `loc` or by position with `iloc`
- Filter with masks; derive columns with array operations
- Summarise groups, join lookup tables and export reports

GUI Toolkits

Inheritance
Command-line Programs
Modern Toolbelt
Web Scraping
SQLAlchemy
NumPy
Pandas
GUI Toolkits
APPENDIX Running Other Programs

GUI Toolkits
Installing tkinter
Root Window and Event Loop
Widgets
Widget Values
Choosing a Genre
grid Layout

Events and Callbacks
ttk.Treeview
Treeview and SQLite
Choosing a Toolkit
GUI Trade-offs
Summary : GUI Toolkits

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GUI Toolkits

- A graphical interface accepts input through widgets
- An event loop dispatches keyboard, mouse and window events
- Python has a graphical toolkit in the standard library :
  - `tkinter`, with installation depending on the Python distribution
- A playlist form can add tracks and display saved data

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Installing tkinter

- `tkinter` **ships with Python, but not with every Python package :**
  - The Windows and macOS installers include it
  - Most Linux distributions split it into a separate package
- **On Debian and Ubuntu it is one command :**

```
sudo apt install python3-tk
```

- **Check it before writing any code :**

```
python -c "import tkinter; print(tkinter.TkVersion)"
```

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Root Window and Event Loop

- **A graphical program has a different shape from a script :**
  - A script runs top to bottom and exits
  - A window is created, then waits
- **`Tk()` is the root window, and there is exactly one**
- **`mainloop()` waits for an event, dispatches it, and waits again :**
  - It does not return until the window is destroyed
  - Nothing written after it runs before then

```
root = tk.Tk()
root.title("Playlist")
root.mainloop()
```

demo01 · gui_root_window

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Widgets

- **Three widgets carry most simple forms :**
  - `Label` shows text, `Entry` takes text, `Button` does something
- **Prefer the themed `ttk` versions over the plain `tk` ones :**
  - Same names, native appearance
- **A widget is created with its parent as the first argument**
- **`command=` takes the function itself, without parentheses**

```
entry = ttk.Entry(root, width=30)
entry.grid(row=0, column=1, padx=8, pady=8)
```

Widget Values

- **A widget owns its value, and is asked for it rather than tracked :**
  - `entry.get()` reads what the user typed
  - `label.configure(text=...)` writes it back
- `configure()` **sets any option after construction**
- **The callback is an ordinary function :**
  - It runs when the event happens, not when it is registered

```
def add_track() -> None:
    title = entry.get().strip()
    if not title:
        result.configure(text="Enter a title first")
        return
    playlist.append((title, genre.get()))
    result.configure(text=f"{title}: {genre.get()} ({len(playlist)} tracks)")
    entry.delete(0, tk.END)
```

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Choosing a Genre

- `Combobox` combines a text field with a list of choices
- `state="readonly"` limits input to those choices
- `set` selects a value; `get` reads it

```
genre = ttk.Combobox(root, values=["Rock", "Pop", "Soul", "Country", "Electronic"],
                     state="readonly")
genre.set("Rock")
```

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grid Layout

- **Widgets do not place themselves, a geometry manager places them**
- **`grid` puts a widget in a row and a column :**
  - `sticky` takes compass points, so `"e"` pins right and `"ew"` fills
  - `padx` and `pady` add space around the widget
  - `columnspan` lets one widget sit across several columns
- **A widget stretches only if its row or column is given a weight :**
  - Weight is a share of the spare space, not a yes or no

```
ttk.Label(form, text=f"{field} :").grid(row=row, column=0, sticky="e", padx=(0, 8), pady=4)
entry = ttk.Entry(form)
entry.grid(row=row, column=1, sticky="ew", pady=4)
entries[field] = entry
```

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Events and Callbacks

- `bind()` **maps an event pattern to a callback :**
  - `<Key>` is any key, `<Key-a>` is one key, `<Button-1>` is a left click
  - `<Configure>` fires when the widget is resized
- **Every bound callback is handed one argument, the event :**
  - It carries `x` , `y` , `keysym` and the widget it happened on
- **A `Button` 's `command=` is the same idea with the event thrown away**

```
root.bind("<Key>", lambda event: report(f"key {event.keysym}", event))
canvas.bind("<Button-1>", lambda event: report("left click", event))
canvas.bind("<Configure>", lambda event: report("resized", event))
```

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ttk.Treeview

- `ttk.Treeview` **is a real table, with headings and columns**
- **Rows are inserted, and each one gets an identifier back**
- **Clicking a heading can re-order the rows :**
  - `tree.set` reads one cell, `tree.move` re-places a row
- **The widget most internal tools need :**
  - Most internal tools are a table of something with a filter above it

```
tree = ttk.Treeview(root, columns=list(COLUMNS), show="headings", selectmode="browse")
for row in rows:
    tree.insert("", tk.END, values=[row[name] for name in COLUMNS], tags=(tag,))
```

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Treeview and SQLite

- **The same table, filled from SQLite instead of a CSV :**
  - Type a filter, press Return, run the query, refill the table
- **The user's text is a parameter, never formatted into the SQL :**
  - Exactly as in the scraping module

```
sql = f"SELECT {', '.join(COLUMNS)} FROM tracks"
parameters: tuple[str, ...] = ()
if term:
    sql += " WHERE artist LIKE ? OR genre LIKE ? OR title LIKE ?"
    parameters = (f"%{term}%",) * 3
sql += " ORDER BY title"
connection = sqlite3.connect(DB)
found = connection.execute(sql, parameters).fetchall()
connection.close()
return found
```

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Choosing a Toolkit

- `tkinter` :
  - In the standard library
  - Plain, dated, acceptable
  - Small tools and dialogs
- `PySide6` , the Qt binding :
  - A large install
  - Native and modern
  - Real desktop applications
- `Streamlit` :
  - Opens a browser tab
  - No event loop, no callbacks
  - Dashboards over data
- Model and view :
  - `tkinter` holds the rows itself
  - Qt asks a model for them
  - Which matters at scale

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GUI Trade-offs

- **A graphical program costs more than it looks :**
  - It cannot be run from cron, piped, or driven from a script
  - It needs a display, which rules out most servers
  - It is harder to test than anything else in this course
- **Reach for a window when the user is not you :**
  - And reach for a command-line tool when the user is
- **The command-line tools cover most of the middle ground :**
  - A clear `--help`, real exit codes, and a table printed with `rich`

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Summary : GUI Toolkits

- **A GUI inverts the shape of a program :**
  - Build the widgets, then hand control to an event loop
- **`tkinter` is the standard-library binding to Tcl/Tk :**
  - `python3-tk` on Debian and Ubuntu
- **Three widgets and one geometry manager cover most forms :**
  - `Label`, `Entry`, `Button`, placed with `grid`
- **`ttk.Treeview` is the widget most internal tools actually need**
- **Qt and Streamlit are the other two answers, and both are in `reference/gui/`**

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Running Other Programs

Inheritance
Command-line Programs
Modern Toolbelt
Web Scraping
SQLAlchemy
NumPy
Pandas
GUI Toolkits
APPENDIX Running Other Programs

Running Other Programs
subprocess.run
Capturing Output
Exit Codes
Argument Lists
Standard Input and Pipelines

Timeouts
Environment and Working Directory
Missing Programs
Popen and Streaming Output
pathlib Alternatives
Summary : Running Other Programs

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Running Other Programs

- **Some work belongs to a program that already exists :**
  - `git`, `systemctl`, `rsync`, a vendor’s command-line tool
- `subprocess` **starts it, waits for it, and reports back**
- **This is the module for the script that has outgrown its shell :**
  - The logic got complicated, the quoting got worse
  - The commands themselves were never the problem
- **Everything here is standard library, so there is nothing to install**

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subprocess.run

- `run()` starts the program, waits, and returns a `CompletedProcess`
- The command is a list : the program, then each argument separately
- Nothing is captured unless you ask, so output goes straight to the terminal

```
finished = subprocess.run(["git", "--version"], check=False)

print()
print("type       :", type(finished).__name__)
print("args       :", finished.args)
print("returncode :", finished.returncode)
print("stdout     :", finished.stdout)
```

demo01 · running_a_command

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Capturing Output

- `capture_output=True` **fills in** `stdout` **and** `stderr`
- `text=True` **makes them strings rather than bytes :**
  - Without it you get `b'18\n'`, which is almost never wanted
- **After that it is ordinary Python, not a shell pipeline**

```
finished = subprocess.run(
    ["wc", "-l", str(DATA / "listening.log")],
    capture_output=True,
    text=True,
    check=True,
)

print("stdout repr :", repr(finished.stdout))
print("stripped    :", finished.stdout.strip())
print("stderr      :", repr(finished.stderr))
```

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Exit Codes

- **A non-zero exit is information, not always a failure :**
  - `grep` exits 1 when it did not match
- **`check=False` and read `returncode` yourself when the code is meaningful**
- **`check=True` raises `CalledProcessError` when it is not**

```
for pattern in ("ERROR", "NOTHING-MATCHES-THIS"):
    found = subprocess.run(
        ["grep", "-c", pattern, str(LOG)], capture_output=True, text=True, check=False
    )
    print(f"{pattern:<22} returncode={found.returncode}  matched={found.stdout.strip()}")
```

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Argument Lists

- **A list hands the arguments to the program directly :**
  - No shell starts, so nothing splits and nothing expands
- **`shell=True` hands the whole string to a shell first :**
  - A space in a filename becomes two arguments
  - Punctuation becomes syntax

```
listed = subprocess.run(
    ["wc", "-l", str(awkward)], capture_output=True, text=True, check=False
)
print(f"as a list  : rc={listed.returncode}  {listed.stdout.strip()}")
```

demo04 · a_list_not_a_string

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Standard Input and Pipelines

- `input=` writes to the child's stdin and closes it
- Two commands join without a shell :
  - Run the first, capture it, hand the text to the second
- Clearer than a pipeline string, with nothing for a shell to misread

```
tallied = subprocess.run(
    ["sort"], input=levels.stdout, capture_output=True, text=True, check=True
)
summary = subprocess.run(
    ["uniq", "-c"], input=tallied.stdout, capture_output=True, text=True, check=True
)
```

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Timeouts

- **A child that hangs will hang the parent for ever**
- **`timeout=` kills it and raises `TimeoutExpired` :**
  - Nothing is left running behind you
- **Any command touching a network, a device or another machine wants one**

```
try:
    subprocess.run(slow, timeout=1.5, check=True)
except subprocess.TimeoutExpired as error:
    print("raised   :", type(error).__name__)
    print("command  : a sleep of 30 seconds")
    print("waited   :", error.timeout, "seconds")
    print("running behind you.")
```

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Environment and Working Directory

- **The child inherits this process's environment by default**
- **`env=` replaces it wholesale :**
  - Copy `os.environ` and add to the copy, or the child loses `PATH`
- **`cwd=` runs the command elsewhere without moving yourself :**
  - Better than `os.chdir()`, which changes it for everything

```
environment = os.environ.copy()
environment["GREETING"] = "set for the child only"
subprocess.run([sys.executable, "-c", CHILD], env=environment, check=True)
```

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Missing Programs

- A missing command raises `FileNotFoundError`, not a non-zero exit
- `shutil.which()` answers the question without running anything
- Check dependencies at the start of a script, not at the point of use :
  - Failing immediately with a clear message beats failing halfway through

```
for program in ("git", "grep", "definitely-not-installed"):
    location = shutil.which(program)
    print(f"{program:<26} {location or '-- not on PATH'}")
```

demo08 · finding_the_program

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Popen and Streaming Output

- `run()` returns nothing until the command has finished
- `Popen` starts the process and hands back control immediately :
  - Iterating `stdout` yields lines as the child flushes them
- Use it for anything long enough that silence looks like a hang

```
with subprocess.Popen(
    [sys.executable, "-c", CHILD],
    stdout=subprocess.PIPE,
    text=True,
    bufsize=1,
) as process:
    # Iterating the pipe yields lines as the child flushes them.
    for line in process.stdout:
        print("  received :", line.rstrip())
```

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pathlib Alternatives

- Starting a process costs time and brings quoting with it
- Python already does most of what the small commands do :

```
ls *.log      ->  Path.glob              basename  ->  Path.name
wc -l         ->  str.splitlines         test -f   ->  Path.exists
grep          ->  a comprehension        find      ->  Path.rglob
cp / mv / rm ->  shutil.copy, Path.rename, Path.unlink
```

- Reach for `subprocess` when the work belongs to another program

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Summary : Running Other Programs

- `subprocess.run()` starts a program, waits, and reports back
- Pass a list, not a string, and leave `shell=True` alone
- `capture_output=True` with `text=True` to read what it printed
- `check=True` to raise on failure, `check=False` when the code means something
- `timeout=` on anything that could hang
- `shutil.which()` to fail early with a clear message
- `Popen` when you need the output as it arrives
- And `pathlib` instead, for anything the filesystem already does